

# PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design

Term 2 Spring 2026 | Goldsmiths Psychology

Gordon Wright

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## Welcome

Welcome to PS50008A Research Methods & Experimental Design. This module introduces the fundamental principles of psychological research, experimental design, and statistical analysis.

### ! First Week

NO LECTURE IN WEEK 11 - Employability session with the rest of the undergrad cohort!

Your first Research Methods session is **Thursday of Week 11** in the labs. Read the preview reading before attending.

## Module Overview

|                    |                                                              |
|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Module Code</b> | PS50008A                                                     |
| <b>Credits</b>     | 30 (Level 3 / Foundation)                                    |
| <b>Term</b>        | 2 (January - March 2026)                                     |
| <b>Module Lead</b> | Gordon Wright                                                |
| <b>Contact</b>     | <a href="mailto:g.wright@gold.ac.uk">g.wright@gold.ac.uk</a> |

## What You'll Learn

This module teaches you to think like a researcher:

- **Design** experiments that can actually answer your questions
- **Analyse** data using both conceptual understanding and practical R skills
- **Interpret** results appropriately (including knowing what you *can't* claim)
- **Report** findings in professional APA format
- **Collaborate** on a real research project

## DataLab

In Week 11, you'll participate in **DataLab**—a series of cognitive tasks and group activities that generate the dataset you'll analyse throughout the term. This means you'll learn statistics using *your own data*, not abstract examples.

## Assessments

There are four assessments, all in Term 2:

| Assessment      | Weight | Due                     |
|-----------------|--------|-------------------------|
| Research Plan   | 20%    | Fri 27 Feb<br>(Week 16) |
| MCQ Exam        | 20%    | Mon 9 Mar<br>(Week 18)  |
| EDS Assignment  | 20%    | Fri 20 Mar<br>(Week 20) |
| Research Report | 40%    | Fri 1 May (Week<br>22)  |

See the Assessments page for full details.

## Weekly Structure

Each week typically includes:

| Component              | Description                         |
|------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| <b>Lecture</b>         | Core concepts and theory (recorded) |
| <b>Lecture Reading</b> | Textbook content for the week       |
| <b>Lab</b>             | Hands-on practical work with R      |
| <b>Lab Activity</b>    | Interactive WebR exercises          |
| <b>Self-Assessment</b> | Weekly consolidation exercises      |

## Teaching Team

| Role           | Name             | Contact             |
|----------------|------------------|---------------------|
| Module Lead    | Dr Gordon Wright | g.wright@gold.ac.uk |
| Lab Instructor | Dr Bence Palfi   |                     |

## Getting Started

1. Read the Syllabus for full module information

2. Check the Schedule for dates and topics
3. Review the Assessments to understand what's expected
4. Prepare for Week 11 by reading the module intro

## **Quick Links**

### **This Week**

- Week 11: DataLab

### **Key Pages**

- Schedule
- Assessments
- Resources